

Rank a Service Business Across a Region With Satellite-Town Location Pages

Instead of losing to everyone on the high-difficulty metro keyword, claim the ring of smaller towns nobody targets — and sort those towns by revenue-per-lead, not search volume. Distilled from Jonathan Schübler's Unscripted SEO interview with host Jeremy Rivera.

Objective

Win top-4 local rankings across a whole service region by building genuinely differentiated location pages for the dozens of surrounding towns your competitors ignore — prioritized by where a booking is actually worth the most, not by raw click volume.

Key Steps

1. **List every town in your real service radius.** Define how far you'll travel to serve a customer, then list every town inside it. Jonathan travels up to 2.5 hours and built a list of ~80 towns.
2. **Skip the high-difficulty metro keyword.** Don't chase the flagship city term (e.g. "wedding photographer Heidelberg") — everyone, even locals in the surrounding towns, competes for it. Target the ring instead; he ranks top-4 for ~50 towns nobody targets.
3. **Sort towns by revenue-per-lead, not volume.** A term like "wedding photographer Kronberg" gets ~10 clicks/month — but one booking there is a month's income. Rank your list by where the money is, then work top-down.
4. **Build one differentiated page per town.** Use real location pages and service-and-location hybrid pages — not one template with the town name swapped in.
5. **Give every page unique local proof.** Add genuinely useful local content (Jonathan's venue walkthrough videos outranked the venues' own sites). Thin, near-duplicate pages get filtered.
6. **Wire up your Google Business Profile.** Link all your social accounts there so Google pulls your whole entity together and connects off-site signals to your local pages.
7. **Track rankings and inquiries per town, then expand.** Watch which towns hit top-4 and produce inquiries, and add more towns to the list as you win.

Cautionary Notes

- There's a limit where Google cracks down on doorway pages — one region's page just repeated for another. Each page must be genuinely different.
- Don't bloat pages with ChatGPT filler. Thin or plagiarized content drags the whole site down; if 80% of a site is bad, the good 20% won't be trusted.
- Volume-only keyword selection is the trap — ranking #5 for a 1,000-click term can lose to ranking #1 for the 10-click term where the money is.

Tips for Efficiency

- In your keyword tool, sort the town list by revenue-per-lead / booking value, then filter — don't default to volume.
- Feed the pages with one repurposed asset across channels (YouTube → TikTok/Shorts → blog), then link back to the location pages.
- Organize location pages into hub pages by city and by style so they interlink and reinforce each other.
- Compare yourself to the biggest company in your niche to see the content structure Google expects.

Source: Jonathan Schübler, freelance SEO & wedding photographer — who reframed local SEO as a satellite-town game: skip the contested metro keyword and rank the ring of towns "no one's targeting," chosen by revenue-per-booking rather than click volume.

Full interview: unscriptedseo.com/how-one-freelancer-ranks-in-50-german-towns-with-programmatic-seo/ · Listen: the-unscripted-seo-interview-podcast.castos.com